

◀ KILIÇ

Date c.1500

Origin Anatolia

Weight 1.15kg (2½lb)

Length 95cm (37½in)

Long, single-edged cavalry sabres that curved slightly from the hilt were characteristic of Central Asian Turkic groups. Known as *kiliç*, they came into common use in the Islamic world from the 11th century.



Gilt plume-holder

Mail coat with long sleeves



▲ MAMLUK HELMET

Date 15th century

Origin Anatolia

Material Iron

This turban-style iron helmet is typical of Mamluk protective headgear. Despite bearing a rich silver damascened inscription, it was for battlefield use, and would have been lined and fitted with a metal aventail.

► MAIL SHIRT

Date Late 15th century

Origin Anatolia

Material Iron

Known as the *zirh*, this type of mail coat was particularly common in Anatolia and the Levant for several centuries before the 15th century. The iron rings were riveted together.

Riveted iron rings



► ISLAMIC SHIELD

Date Late 15th century

Origin Anatolia

Weight 1.67kg (3½lb)

Diameter 45.8cm (18in)

This type of shield was characteristic of the cavalry of the Ak Koyunlu. It had a high steel boss and, in battle, was generally strapped to the wearer's left arm. It was embellished with a geometric pattern.

Embellished outer rim

